

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.8: Prefaces and the Roman Canon

Hold a long liturgical period together through its finite spine, infinitive frame, relative chains, object series, and destinations

Stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisite	EL-III.7 and accurate reconstruction of compressed order
Next	EL-III.9, The Temporal Cycle

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

Contents

I	Lesson	1
1	Prefaces and the Roman Canon	1
1.1	The Preface frame	1
1.2	The opening petition of the Canon	2
1.3	Predicate adjectives in the <i>Quam oblationem</i>	2
1.4	Command plus passive infinitive	2
1.5	Canon families	2
II	Practice	3
1	Transfer, retrieval, and application	3
1.1	The Preface frame — transfer practice	3
1.2	The opening petition of the Canon — transfer practice	3
1.3	Predicate adjectives in the <i>Quam oblationem</i> — transfer practice	3
1.4	Command plus passive infinitive — transfer practice	3
1.5	Canon families — transfer practice	4
III	Worksheets	5
1	Unit III.8: Prefaces and Roman Canon	5
	Worksheet III.29 — Variant A	5
	Worksheet III.32 — Variant D	6
IV	Assessment	7
1	Mastery assessment and record	7
V	Answer Key	8
1	Practice models and rubrics	8
2	Unit III.8: Prefaces and Roman Canon	9
	Solution III.29 — Variant A	9
	Solution III.32 — Variant D	10
VI	Scope and Sources	11
1	Scope and Qualifications	11
1.1	Packet boundary	11
1.2	Controlling records and local state	11
2	References	11
2.1	Primary corpus	11
2.2	Grammar and lexicography	12
2.3	Citation convention	12
3	Generation Metadata	12

Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Prefaces and the Roman Canon

On completing this unit, you can:

- hold a long periodic sentence in memory by identifying its frame;
- read formulaic accusative–infinitive and *uti*-clauses;
- resolve the Canon’s adjective chains and relative clauses;
- distinguish grammatical familiarity from theological paraphrase.

The Preface begins with a stable frame and inserts a seasonal reason for praise. The Canon is highly formulaic but syntactically dense. Because both become familiar by hearing, use random-entry drills: begin at a clause chosen by page and line, identify its governor, then reconnect it to the whole.

The **Preface** is the thanksgiving prayer introduced by the Preface dialogue and concluded by the angelic praise leading into the Sanctus. The **Roman Canon** is the fixed Eucharistic Prayer of the 1962 Roman Mass, beginning *Te igitur* and ending with its doxology. A text is **formulaic** when stable wording or structures recur as recognized formulas; formulaic does not mean syntactically unanalyzable. A **periodic sentence** keeps a governing construction incomplete while dependent members accumulate toward its resolution. Its **frame** is the stable outer construction into which those members fit.

1.1 The Preface frame

When this chapter asks for the **frame**, mark the minimum words that remain syntactically incomplete until the thanksgiving action is supplied. Material inserted within that frame explains why the action is fitting; it does not become a second main sentence merely because it is long.

Vere dignum et iustum est, æquum et salutare, nos tibi semper et ubique gratias agere: Domine sancte, Pater omnipotens, æterne Deus.

Source: Missale Romanum (1962), Præfatio communis and common Preface opening.

The delayed infinitive clause is the true subject of impersonal *est: nos* is accusative subject of *agere, gratias* its object, and *tibi* dative. Four neuter predicate adjectives evaluate that action. The three vocative titles are appositional; *æterne* is vocative masculine despite its adverb-like appearance.

The Christmas insertion continues:

Quia per incarnati Verbi mysterium nova mentis nostræ oculis lux tuæ claritatis infulsit: ut, dum visibiliter Deum cognoscimus, per hunc in invisibilium amorem rapiamur.

Source: Missale Romanum (1962), Præfatio de Nativitate.

The subject of *infulsit* is *nova ... lux*; dative *mentis nostræ oculis* names the eyes of the mind to which it shone. *tuæ claritatis* defines the light. The purpose/result clause contrasts adverb *visibiliter* with substantival genitive plural *invisibilium*. *per hunc* grammatically resumes masculine *Deum*, the God known visibly in the mystery of the incarnate Word; it cannot agree directly with neuter *Verbi*. Passive *rapiamur* governs motion *in ... amorem*.

1.2 The opening petition of the Canon

Te igitur, clementissime Pater, per Iesum Christum Filium tuum Dominum nostrum, supplices rogamus ac petimus, uti accepta habeas et benedicas hæc dona, hæc munera, hæc sancta sacrificia illibata.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Canon Missæ, *Te igitur*.

The fronted *te* is the object of both *rogamus* and *petimus*; predicative *supplices* describes the implicit *nos*. The *uti*-clause states the request. *accepta habeas* is a resultative idiom: hold or regard the gifts as accepted. *benedicas* shares the threefold object, whose accumulation is rhetorical rather than three unrelated offerings. *Filium tuum Dominum nostrum* is in apposition to *Iesum Christum* after *per*.

1.3 Predicate adjectives in the *Quam oblationem*

Quam oblationem tu, Deus, in omnibus, quæsumus, benedictam, adscriptam, ratam, rationabilem, acceptabilemque facere digneris: ut nobis Corpus et Sanguis fiat dilectissimi Filii tui Domini nostri Iesu Christi.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Canon Missæ, *Quam oblationem*.

Relative *quam oblationem* is the accusative object of *facere*. Five predicate accusatives state what the offering is asked to be made. Deponent *digneris* governs *facere*; *quæsumus* remains parenthetical. In the result clause, singular *fiat* with *Corpus et Sanguis* may reflect proximity agreement or a unit construal; morphology does not decide between them. *nobis* is dative of advantage. The long genitive chain belongs to both body and blood.

1.4 Command plus passive infinitive

Supplices te rogamus, omnipotens Deus: iube hæc perferri per manus sancti Angeli tui in sublime altare tuum, in conspectu divinæ maiestatis tuæ.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Canon Missæ, *Supplices te rogamus*.

Again *supplices* is predicative with implicit *nos*, and *te* is the object of *rogamus*. Imperative *iube* governs passive infinitive *perferri*; neuter plural *hæc* is its accusative subject. The two *in* phrases express destination and presence with different cases: accusative *in sublime altare*, ablative *in conspectu*.

1.5 Canon families

Build a ledger around *memoria*, *memento*, *commemoro*; *offero*, *oblatio*, *munus*; *accipio*, *acceptus*, *acceptabilis*; *benedico*, *benedictus*; *communico*, *communicantes*, *communio*; and *supplex*, *supplices*. Record the construction with each word, not only an English gloss.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 The Preface frame — transfer practice

Connection. The opening predicates anticipate an act that completes their sense.

Transfer task. Copy the lesson's Preface frame, box the predicate series, bracket the completing infinitive unit, and show where its subject is expressed or understood.

Retrieval check. Why are the opening neuter predicates not evidence for a masculine subject?

1.2 The opening petition of the Canon — transfer practice

Connection. Repeated objects and relative links form one governed petition despite intervening modifiers.

Transfer task. Draw the petition's finite spine, then attach every object, apposition, adjective, relative, and recipient in dependency order.

Retrieval check. Name the single governing petition before listing its members.

1.3 Predicate adjectives in the *Quam oblationem* — transfer practice

Connection. A string of agreeing accusatives can describe the object predicatively rather than add new objects.

Transfer task. Use the lesson passage to separate object phrase, governing infinitive, and predicate accusatives; then change the project-composed object to plural and cascade all agreement.

Retrieval check. State the test distinguishing a predicate accusative from an independent object.

1.4 Command plus passive infinitive — transfer practice

Connection. A command may govern an infinitive whose patient and destination must be traced separately.

Transfer task. On the lesson example, label command, infinitive, logical subject or patient, personal agent if any, and both destination phrases.

Retrieval check. Explain why two occurrences of *in* need not govern the same case.

1.5 Canon families — transfer practice

Connection. A family inventory reduces cognitive load without turning formula into one undifferentiated gloss.

Transfer task. Create four construction-aware families from the lesson: petition, offering, acceptance, and commemoration; give one lemma and one governed form for each.

Retrieval check. Retrieve the construction, not merely the English label, for two entries.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit III.8: Prefaces and Roman Canon

Worksheet III.29 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.29

Focus: The Preface frame

Use: Hold the infinitive clause together.

1. **Text:** *Vere dignum et iustum est, æquum et salutare, nos tibi semper et ubique gratias agere: Domine sancte, Pater omnipotens, æterne Deus.*

Passage ID: III.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Identify the subject of *est*, predicate adjectives, and vocatives.

-
2. Why is *æterne* not an adverb?

-
3. Change *nos ... agere* to singular “me to give thanks.”

-
4. Turn the impersonal evaluation into a personal first-plural statement while retaining the four qualities as adverbs where possible.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Cui, quando, et ubi gratias agere dignum est?*

-
6. In the printed sequence, mark all endings in the three vocative titles.
-

Worksheet III.32 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** III.32**Focus:** Canon command and destination**Use:** Distinguish *in* with two cases.

1. **Text:** *Supplices te rogamus, omnipotens Deus: iube hæc perferri per manus sancti Angeli tui in sublime altare tuum, in conspectu divinæ maiestatis tuæ.*

Passage ID: III.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map both petitions and every prepositional phrase.

-
2. Why is *hæc* accusative plural even though its nominative form is identical?

-
3. Give the lemma and full form of *perferri*.

-
4. Explain the case contrast *in altare* / *in conspectu*.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Per cuius manus hæc perferri iubentur?*

-
6. Recast *iube hæc perferri* as an active command to the angel, without claiming it is the Missal text.
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: On an unfamiliar Preface or Canon period, identify the main completion, attach all subordinate and non-finite material, resolve reference and agreement chains, and explain the function of one delayed or repeated member.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-III.9, The Temporal Cycle.

If it is not met: Worksheets III.30 and III.31 remain optional Christmas-Preface and Canon-opening practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

The Preface frame — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model keeps the neuter predicate adjectives with the anticipated act or infinitive construction and identifies the copula. No masculine noun may be invented from English idiom.

The opening petition of the Canon — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A complete diagram begins with the governing verbal center and shows the repeated accusatives as its coordinated or expanding object series; each relative has an explicit antecedent.

Predicate adjectives in the *Quam oblationem* — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The adjectives agree with and are predicated of the same object through the governing construction. In the transformation every linked adjective changes with the object; no new verbal object is introduced.

Command plus passive infinitive — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model attaches the passive infinitive to the command and assigns each *in*-phrase from motion or location and its printed case. A single English preposition is not a sufficient parse.

Canon families — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each accepted entry cites an actual lesson form and names its object, complement, or case government. Entries with only English thematic labels do not pass.

CHAPTER 2

Unit III.8: Prefaces and Roman Canon

Solution III.29 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.29

Focus: The Preface frame

Use: Hold the infinitive clause together.

1. **Text:** *Vere dignum et iustum est, æquum et salutare, nos tibi semper et ubique gratias agere: Domine sancte, Pater omnipotens, æterne Deus.*

Passage ID: III.29.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Identify the subject of *est*, predicate adjectives, and vocatives.

Answer / notes: Accusative-infinitive clause *nos ... gratias agere* is the evaluated action/subject; *nos* accusative subject, *gratias* object, *tibi* dative. Neuter predicates *dignum*, *iustum*, *æquum*, *salutare*. Three vocative titles: *Domine sancte*, *Pater omnipotens*, *æterne Deus*.

2. Why is *æterne* not an adverb?

Answer / model: It is vocative masculine singular of *æternus*, agreeing with vocative *Deus*; the adverb would be *æterne* in identical surface form, so syntax decides.

3. Change *nos ... agere* to singular “me to give thanks.”

Answer / model: *me tibi gratias agere*.

4. Turn the impersonal evaluation into a personal first-plural statement while retaining the four qualities as adverbs where possible.

Answer / model: Model: *Nos tibi semper et ubique digne, iuste atque salutariter gratias agimus*; *æque* would change sense, so it may be omitted or paraphrased.

5. Answer in Latin: *Cui, quando, et ubi gratias agere dignum est?*

Answer / model: *Deo semper et ubique gratias agere dignum est*.

6. In the printed sequence, mark all endings in the three vocative titles.

Answer / model: *Domine sancte*, *Pater omnipotens*, *æterne Deus*: vocative *-e* in *Domine/sancte/æterne*; third-declension *Pater*; vocative=nominative forms *omnipotens/Deus*.

Solution III.32 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.32

Focus: Canon command and destination

Use: Distinguish *in* with two cases.

1. **Text:** *Supplices te rogamus, omnipotens Deus: iube hæc perferri per manus sancti Angeli tui in sublime altare tuum, in conspectu divinæ maiestatis tuæ.*

Passage ID: III.32.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map both petitions and every prepositional phrase.

Answer / notes: *supplices* describes implicit *nos*; *te* object of *rogamus*; vocative *Deus*. Imperative *iube* governs passive infinitive *perferri*; *hæc* accusative subject. *per manus* mediation; *in sublime altare* destination accusative; *in conspectu* location/presence ablative, with genitives.

2. Why is *hæc* accusative plural even though its nominative form is identical?

Answer / model: It is the subject accusative of infinitive *perferri* after *iube*; syntactic function, not shape alone, decides.

3. Give the lemma and full form of *perferri*.

Answer / model: Present passive infinitive of irregular compound *perfero, perferre, pertuli, perlatum*.

4. Explain the case contrast *in altare* / *in conspectu*.

Answer / model: Motion to the altar takes accusative *altare*; being in the sight/presence takes ablative *conspectu*.

5. Answer in Latin: *Per cuius manus hæc perferri iubentur?*

Answer / model: *Hæc per manus sancti Angeli Dei perferri iubentur.*

6. Recast *iube hæc perferri* as an active command to the angel, without claiming it is the Missal text.

Answer / model: Controlled transformation: *Sancte Angele, hæc perfer*. It changes perspective and is not a quotation.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.8, *Prefaces and the Roman Canon*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The packet is linguistic analysis of selected fixed texts, not ceremonial instruction or a theological exposition of the Canon.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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